Safety of navigation

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SHIPS OPERATING IN POLAR WATERS (POLAR CODE)

Part I-A
Safety measures

Chapter 9
Safety of navigation

1 The heading of chapter 9 is replaced by the following:

"Chapter 9
Safety of navigation for ships certified in accordance with SOLAS chapter I"

2 The following text is inserted after the heading of chapter 9:

"This chapter applies to ships certified in accordance with SOLAS chapter I."

3 The following new chapter is inserted after existing chapter 9:

"Chapter 9-1
Safety of navigation for fishing vessels of 24 metres in length overall and above , pleasure yachts of 300 gross tonnage and upwards not engaged in trade and cargo ships of 300 gross tonnage and upwards but below 500 gross tonnage

This chapter applies to:

.1 fishing vessels of 24 metres in length overall and above;

.2 pleasure yachts of 300 gross tonnage and upwards not engaged in trade; and

.3 cargo ships of 300 gross tonnage and upwards but below 500 gross tonnage.

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trade; and

.3 cargo ships of 300 gross tonnage and upwards but below 500 gross tonnage.

9-1.1 Goal

The goal of this chapter is to provide for safe navigation.

9-1.2 Functional requirements

In order to achieve the goal set out in paragraph 9-1.1 above, the following functional requirements are embodied in the regulations of this chapter.

9-1.2.1 Nautical information

Ships shall have the ability to receive up-to-date information including ice information for safe navigation.

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9-1.2.2 Navigational equipment functionality

.1 The navigational equipment and systems shall be designed, constructed and installed to retain their functionality under the expected environmental conditions in the area of operation.

.2 Systems for providing reference headings and position fixing shall
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expected environmental conditions in the area of operation.

.2 Systems for providing reference headings and position fixing shall be suitable for the intended areas.

9-1.2.3 Additional navigational equipment

Ships shall have the ability to visually detect ice when operating in darkness.

9-1.3 Regulations

9-1.3.1 Nautical information

In order to comply with the functional requirement of paragraph 9-1.2.1 above, ships shall have means of receiving and displaying current information on ice conditions in the area of operation.

9-1.3.2 Navigational equipment functionality

9-1.3.2.1 In order to comply with the functional requirement of paragraph 9-1.2.2.1 above, the following applies:

.1 ice-strengthened ships constructed on or after 1 January 2026 shall have either two independent echo -sounding devices or one echo-sounding device with two separate independent transducers. Other devices capable of depth sounding, such as fish finders,
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echo-sounding device with two separate independent transducers. Other devices capable of depth sounding, such as fish finders, acceptable to the Administration, may be used as equivalent means of meeting this requirement;

.2 ships shall comply with SOLAS regulation V/22.1.9.4, irrespective of the date of construction and the size, and have a clear view astern. On ships which cannot comply with these requirements, arrangements acceptable to the Administration shall be provided to achieve a level of visibility that is equivalent to these requirements;

.3 for ships operating in areas, and during periods, where ice accretion is likely to occur, means to prevent the accumulation of ice on antennas required for navigation and communication shall be provided; and

.4 in addition, for ice-strengthened ships, the following applies:

.1 where equipment required by SOLAS chapter V or this chapter have sensors that project below the hull, such
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.1 where equipment required by SOLAS chapter V or this chapter have sensors that project below the hull, such sensors shall be protected against ice; and

.2 in category A and B ships constructed on or after 1 January 2026, the bridge wings shall be enclosed or designed to protect navigational equipment and operating personnel. On ships which cannot comply with this regulation, arrangements acceptable to the Administration shall be provided to achieve a level of protection that is equivalent to this regulation.

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9-1.3.2.2 In order to comply with the functional requirement of paragraph 9-1.2.2.2 above, the following applies:

.1 ships of 500 gross tonnage and upwards shall have two non-magnetic means to determine and display their heading. Both means shall be independent and shall be connected to the
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non-magnetic means to determine and display their heading.
Both means shall be independent and shall be connected to the
ship's main and emergency source of power; and

.2 ships proceeding to latitudes over 80 degrees shall be fitted with at
least one GNSS compass or equivalent, which shall be connected
to the ship's main and emergency source of power.

9-1.3.3 Additional navigational equipment

In order to comply with the functional requirement of paragraph 9 -1.2.3, ships, with
the exception of those solely operating in areas with 24 hours daylight, shall be
equipped with two means of illumination to aid visual detection of ice."

Chapter 11

Voyage planning

4 The heading of chapter 11 is replaced by the following:

"Chapter 11
Voyage planning for ships certified in accordance with chapter I"

5 The following text is inserted after the heading of chapter 11:

"This chapter applies to ships certified in accordance with SOLAS chapter I."

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5 The following text is inserted after the heading of chapter 11:

"This chapter applies to ships certified in accordance with SOLAS chapter I."